www.tienganhedu.com

1 Let's get started

STARTER Work with a partner. Ask the questions below and make a note of the answers. Then tell the group what you found out and discuss.

1. How often do you give presentations in your job?
2. Who do you normally present to? (Colleagues, customers, other firms, etc.)
3. When was the last time you gave a presentation in English? Was it a success? If yes, why? If not, why not? Explain your answer.
4. How do you feel about presenting in a foreign language?
5. Think of an excellent (or terrible) presentation that you have attended. What made it good (or bad)?

AUDIO 2–4

1 Listen to the opening sentences of the three presentations and complete the table.

	Presentation 1	Presentation 2	Presentation 3
Presenter's name	Don Taylor	Charlotte	Susan Webster
Presenter's position/function	Head of Logistics	IT Team Leader	New Human Resources Manager
Topic of presentation	Semi -automatic shelving system.	Project Documentation	Department's new concept
Who is the presentation for?	Customers	International project management	Department Heads

Which presentations are formal and which less formal?

www.tienganhedu.com

2 Listen to the openings again and complete the sentences.

AUDIO 2

Presentation 1

1 Good morning, ladies and gentlemen. First of all, let me thank you all for being here today.

2 Let me introduce myself. My name is ...

3 I'm here today to present our new semi-automatic shelving system.

4 My talk is particularly relevant to those of you who place orders for the different parts we supply.

AUDIO 3

Presentation 2

5 I'm happy that so many of you could make it today at such short notice.

6 As you can see on the screen, our topic today is project documentation.

7 This is extremely important for all of us who are directly involved in international project management, right?

AUDIO 4

Presentation 3

8 I'm aware that you all have very tight schedules, so I appreciate you taking the time to come here today.

9 As you probably know, my name is ... . I'm the new human resources manager here at Weston Ltd.

10 Today's topic will be very important for you as department heads since i'll need your help to evaluate and select candidates for training.

3 Put the sentences from above in the correct category (a–d).

a saying what the topic is: 3 6

b welcoming the audience: 8 1 5

c saying who you are: 2 9

d saying why the topic is relevant for the audience: 10 7 4

Now put a–d in the order you would use to start a presentation.

b c a d

www.tienganhedu.com

4 Match these less formal phrases with the more formal phrases in the table.

What I want to do today is ... | I know you are all very busy ... | As you know, I'm ...

OK, shall we get started? | It's good to see you all here. | Hi, everyone.

Today I'm going to talk about ... | In my talk I'll tell you about ...

More formal	Less formal
Good afternoon, ladies and gentlemen.	1 Hi, Everyone
Today I would like to ...	2 What i want to do today is
Let me just start by introducing myself. My name is ...	3 As you know, i'm
It's a pleasure to welcome you today.	4 It's good to see you all here
In my presentation I would like to report on ...	5 Today i'm going to talk about
The topic of today's presentation is ...	6 In my talk i'll tell you about
I suggest that we begin now.	7 OK, shall we get started?
I'm aware that you all have very tight schedules ...	8 I know you are all very busy

5 Now practise the opening of a presentation. Use phrases from the box and follow the WISE flow chart.

Welcome audience → Introduce yourself → Say what the topic is → Explain why audience will be interested

OPENING A PRESENTATION

Welcoming the audience
Good morning/afternoon, ladies and gentlemen.
Hello/Hi, everyone.
First of all, let me thank you all for coming here today.
I'm happy/delighted that so many of you could make it today.

Introducing yourself
Let me introduce myself. I'm Dave Elwood from ...
For those of you who don't know me, my name's ...
As you probably know, I'm the new HR manager.
I'm head of logistics here at Air Spares.
I'm here in my function as the Head of Controlling.

Saying what your topic is
As you can see on the screen, our topic today is ...
Today's topic is ...
What I'd like to present to you today is ...
The subject of my presentation is ...

Explaining why your topic is relevant for your audience
My talk is particularly relevant to those of you/us who ...
Today's topic is of particular interest to those of you/us who ...
My/The topic is very important for you because ...
By the end of this talk you will be familiar with ...

! Remember to use words like *we*, *us*, and *our* to highlight common interest.

www.tienganhedu.com

STRUCTURING A PRESENTATION (1)

Most formal – and many informal – presentations have three main parts and follow this simple formula:

1 Tell the audience what you are going to say! = Introduction
2 Say it! = Main part
3 Tell them what you said! = Conclusion

There are several ways you can tell the audience what you are going to say.

***would like* + infinitive**
*Today I'**d like to tell** you about our new plans.*
*This morning I'**d like to bring** you up to date on our department.*

***will* + infinitive**
*I'**ll begin** by explaining the function.*
*I'**ll start off** by reviewing our progress.*
*After that, I'**ll move** on to my next point.*

***going to* + infinitive**
*I'**m going to talk** to you today about new developments in the R & D Department.*
*This afternoon I'**m going to be reporting** on the new division.*

will be* + verb *-ing
*I'**ll be talking** about our guidelines for Internet use.*
*During the next hour we'**ll be looking** at the advantages of this system.*

6 Complete sentences 1–8 with the correct form of the verb and a sentence ending from below.

~~you on the proposed training project~~

~~you up to date on SEKO's investment plans~~

~~you how the database works~~

~~you an overview of our present market position~~

~~at business opportunities in Asia~~

~~on our financial targets for the division~~

~~by telling you about what Jane's group is working on~~

~~about EU tax reform~~

1 give Today I'd like to *give you an overview of our present market position.*
2 show I'll be *showing* you how the database works
3 talk During the next two hours we'll be talk about EU tax reform
4 bring I'd like to bring you up to date on SEKO's investment plans
5 report This afternoon I'm going to you on the proposed training project
6 update Today I'd like to update on our financial targets for the division
7 look This morning we'll be look ar bussines opportunities in Asia
8 begin Today I'll begin by telling you about what Jane's group is working on

www.tienganhedu.com

STRUCTURING A PRESENTATION (2)

The purpose of the introduction is not only to tell the audience who you are, what the talk is about, and why it is relevant to them; you also want to tell the audience (briefly) how the talk is structured. Here are some useful phrases to talk about the structure.

I've divided *my presentation* ***into*** *three (main) parts: x, y, and z.*
In my presentation ***I'll focus on*** *three major issues.*
First (of all), *I'll be looking at ...,* ***second*** *...,* *and* ***third*** *...*
I'll begin / start off by *explaining ...*
Then / Next / After that, *I'll go on to ...*
Finally, *I'll offer some solutions.*

! The most common way to structure a presentation is to have three main parts, and then subdivide them into (three) smaller sections.

7 Complete the sentences with the words in the box.

after • all • areas • divided • finally • start • then • third

1

I'll be talking to you today about the after-sales service plans we offer. I'll ___start___[1] by describing the various packages in detail. ___then___[2] I'll go on to show you some case studies. ___finally___[3], I'll discuss how you can choose the best plan to meet your customers' needs.

2

I've ___divided___[4] my talk into three main parts. First of ___all___[5], I'll tell you something about the history of our company. ___after___[6] that I'll describe how the company is structured and finally, I'll give you some details about our range of products and services.

3

I'd like to update you on what we've been working on over the last year. I'll focus on three main ___areas___[7]: first, our joint venture in Asia; second, the new plant in Charleston. And ___third___[8], our redevelopment project.

8 Complete the sentences with the prepositions in the box.

about • at • for • into • of • on • to • with

1 Thank you ___for___ coming all this way.
2 I've divided my presentation ___into___ three parts.
3 First of all, I'll give you an overview ___at___ our financial situation.
4 First, we'll be looking ___of___ the company's sales in the last two quarters.
5 In the first part of my presentation I'll focus ___on___ the current project status.
6 Point one deals ___about___ APG's new regulations for Internet use.
7 Secondly, I'll talk ___with___ our investment in office technology.
8 After that I'll move on ___to___ the next point.

www.tienganhedu.com

AUDIO 5

9 The project manager of a construction company is giving a presentation to his colleagues. Put the sentences in the right order. Then listen and check.

4 a This morning I'd like to update you on the current status of work at the construction site. The information I give you today should help you with planning your next steps.

3 b For those of you who don't know me, my name is Gordon Selfridge. Let me just write that down for you. OK. I'm the project manager in charge of the Bak Tower building project in Dubai.

5 c I've divided my presentation into three parts.

1 d Hello, everyone.

7 e Then I'll move on to the problems we're facing with our local suppliers.

2 f First of all, let me thank you for coming here today. I'm aware that you're all busy preparing for the annual meeting this week, so I really appreciate you taking the time to be here.

6 g I'll start off by showing you some photos of the building site and discussing the progress we've made since January.

9 h My talk should take about 30 minutes. Please feel free to interrupt me at any time with questions.

8 i I'll end with some ideas for reducing labour costs that we've been looking into.

10 j Oh, and don't worry about taking notes. I'll be handing out copies of the PowerPoint slides.

Now put these points in the order in which Gordon mentions them.

A *reducing labour costs* 8

D *update on current status* 4

G *problems with local suppliers* 7

B *welcome & introduction* 1, 2, 3

E *handout after presentation* 10

H *questions during presentation OK* 9

C *30 minutes for presentation* 9

F *progress made since January* 6

I *three main parts* 5

www.tienganhedu.com

10 **Look again at these sentences from the presentation and replace the highlighted words with words or phrases from the box.**

after that • begin • I'm • realize • responsible for • sections • turn

1 I'll start off by showing you ... *I'll begin by showing you ...*

2 I've divided my presentation into three parts. i've divided my presentation into three sections

3 For those of you who don't know me, my name is Gordon Smith. For those of you who don't know me I'm Gordon Smith

4 Then I'll move on to the problems ... After that, i'll turn to the problems

5 I'm the project manager in charge of our Dubai building project. I'm the project manager responsible for our Dubai building project

6 I'm aware that you're all busy preparing for the annual meeting ... i'm realize that you're all busy preparing for the annual meeting

ORGANIZATION

The final part of the introduction deals with the organization of the talk: how long it will last, whether there will be handouts, and how questions will be handled.

Timing
My presentation will take about 20 minutes.
It should take about 30 minutes to cover these issues.

Handouts
Does everybody have a handout/brochure/report? Please take one, and pass them on.
Don't worry about taking notes. I've put all the important statistics on a handout for you.
I'll be handing out copies of the PowerPoint slides at the end of my talk.
I'll email the PowerPoint presentation to you.

Questions
There will be time for questions after my presentation.
If you have any questions, feel free to interrupt me at any time.
Feel free to ask questions at any time during my talk.

11 **Match the two parts to make typical sentences from the introduction.**

1	For those of you who don't know me,	a	to take notes. Everything is on the handout.
2	Feel free to	b	about 10 minutes.
3	This won't take more	c	I'm Bob Kay in charge of the software division.
4	I'll be passing out	d	ask questions at any time.
5	This part of the presentation will take	e	for questions after my talk.
6	I'll start off by giving you	f	an overview of our product range.
7	There's no need	g	handouts in a few minutes.
8	There will be time	h	than 20 minutes of your time.

www.tienganhedu.com

AUDIO 6–9

12 **Listen to the beginnings of four presentations. Which one starts with:**

a a rhetorical question? Audio 9
b an interesting fact? Audio 8
c an anecdote? Audio 6
d a problem to think about? Audio 7

AUDIO 6–9

Listen again and complete the sentences.

1 You Know, I was sitting in the waiting room at the dentist's the other day when I came across something very interesting in one of the magazines that was lying there.

2 Imagine you worked in a small to medium-sized company and were responsible for making people in your company aware of health and safety issues. How would you have a meeting?

3 Did you know that the number of possible ways of playing the first four moves per side in a game of chess is ...?

4 So, let me start by asking you a question. Why should we introduce a double quality check here at Auto Spares & Parts ...? Well, I'm here today to tell you why.

GETTING THE AUDIENCE'S ATTENTION

Experts say that the first few minutes of a presentation are the most important. If you are able to get the audience's attention quickly, they will be interested in what you have to say. Here are a few techniques you can use to start your talk.

Ask a rhetorical question
Is market research important for brand development?
Do we really need quality assurance?

Start with an interesting fact
According to an article I read recently, central banks are now buying euros instead of dollars.
Did you know that fast food consumption has increased by 600% in Europe since 2002?

Tell them a story or anecdote
I remember when I attended a meeting in Paris. ...
At a conference in Madrid, I was once asked the following question: ...

Give them a problem to think about
Suppose you wanted to set up a new call centre. How would you go about it?
Imagine you had to reorganize the sales department. What would be your first step?

13 **Match items from the three columns to make attention-grabbing openings.**

1	Did you know that	that *can't* is a four-letter word.	Who would you tell first?
2	I read in an article somewhere	compete with the Chinese?	by eliminating one olive from each salad served in first-class?
3	Imagine	American Airlines saved $40,000 in 1987	Of course we can!
4	Can we really	you won a million euros.	I tend to agree with that!

What presentation topics could you use each of the openings above for? Choose one of the openings and use it to practise the introduction of a talk.

1. Did you know that American Airlines saved $40.000 in 1987 by eliminating one olive from each salad served in first-class

2. Can we really compete with the Chinese? I tend to agree with that!

3. Imagine you won a million euros Who would you tell first

4. I read in an article somewhere that can't is a four-letter word Of course we can!

www.tienganhedu.com

14 **Put the words in the right order to make sentences with expressions from this unit.**

1 shall OK get we started OK shall we get started
2 my today subject presentation of satisfaction is the customer My presentation subject today is customer satisfaction.
3 will presentation thirty my about take minutes my presentation will take about thirty minutes
4 issues on three focus I'll I'll focus on three issues
5 by looking of status will the current project we the start at We will start the current project by looking at the status.
6 that did know popular China car is this very in you DId you know that this car is very popular in china

15 **Put the notes in the correct order, then prepare two openings of a presentation: a formal one and a less formal one. Use the checklist for introductions below if you need help.**

A B. Miller, product manager, FIT-Healthcare 2

B 20 minutes 6

F promotional video 3

C relevant for sales staff 4

G three parts 5

D products 3

H new wellness products 3

E questions at end 7

I welcome, etc. 1

CHECKLIST FOR INTRODUCTIONS

- ✓ 1 Welcome the audience.
- ✓ 2 Introduce yourself (name, position/function).
- ✓ 3 State your topic.
- ✓ 4 Explain why your topic is important for the audience.
- ✓ 5 Outline the structure of your talk.
- ✓ 6 'What comes when?' say when you'll be dealing with each point.
- ✓ 7 Let the audience know how you're organizing the presentation (handouts, questions, etc.).

16 **Now it's your turn. Think of a talk you have given or would like to give and use the checklist to prepare your introduction. Try to use phrases from this unit.**

www.tienganhedu.com

OUTPUT **Read this article from a website on business communication and discuss the questions which follow.**

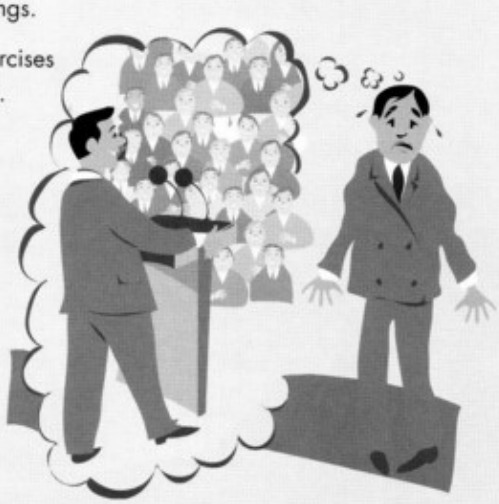
Dealing with nervousness

The American author Mark Twain once put it like this: 'There are two types of people: those that are nervous and those that are liars.' So, once you accept that (almost) everybody who gives a presentation – whether formal or informal, long or short, to strangers or colleagues – is nervous, then you just need to find ways to deal with nervousness and even learn how to use it to your advantage.

Let's first look at ways to deal with and reduce nervousness.

1 **Prepare well.** 'Failing to prepare is preparing to fail.' Preparation is the key to a successful presentation. Nothing will relax you more than knowing exactly what you want to say and having practised saying it. Make sure you practise your talk until you feel at home with it – then you can concentrate on other things.

2 **Learn to relax.** Doing stretching or breathing exercises before your talk can help you to reduce nervousness. One example: before your presentation, sit comfortably with your back straight. Breathe in slowly, hold your breath for about five seconds, then slowly exhale. You can relax your facial muscles by opening your eyes and mouth wide, then closing them tightly.



3 **Check out the room.** Make yourself familiar with the place where you will be speaking. Arrive early, walk around the room, and make sure everything you need for your talk is there. Practise using any equipment (e.g. microphone, video projector, OHP) you plan to work with.

4 **Know your audience.** If possible, greet your audience as they arrive and chat with them. It will be easier to speak to people who are not complete strangers.

5 **Concentrate on the message.** Try to focus on the message and your audience – not on your own fears.

6 **Visualize success.** Imagine yourself speaking to your audience in a loud and clear voice. Then visualize the audience applauding loudly at the end of your talk as you smile.

Use the steps above to reduce nervousness, but also remember that being nervous isn't all bad. Many experienced presenters say that you can also use your nervousness to give you that extra energy that you need to give a good performance.

OVER TO YOU

What other tips can you think of for dealing with nervousness?
How do you deal with nervousness before or during a presentation?
How do you prepare your presentations?